In the last twenty minutes, Argentina got hold of the ball and started to play. It wasn't that they looked that good: they were just keeping possession by force of will more than anything. We couldn't seem to stop them piling forward. *Please don't score*. I was starting to feel really tired; this was only my second game since I'd broken my foot. I remember Sven calling across to me with about ten minutes to go:

'David, are you all right?'

I didn't shout back. The expression on my face said it all. *Don't even think about taking me off. I've got to be on when we win this.*

Argentina were firing in shots and crosses. And they had some good chances. For supporters watching on television at home, that final quarter of an hour must have been unbearable. Dave Seaman made a couple of great saves. Sol and Rio kept diving in the way of Argentinian attempts on goal. It was fantastic but I wanted it over. I was out there trying to defend with the rest of the lads but half-wishing I could be hiding behind the sofa with my eyes shut, like the England supporters back home.

When the final whistle blew, Rio and Trevor came running towards me. Such a great, great feeling. For us and for the fans. I phoned Victoria out in the tunnel about half an hour after the game. I was well past putting things into words by then and couldn't hear a word she was saying either. She was at her mum and dad's. They had a houseful of family and friends, all of them shouting and singing away in the background. Later on, I called Dave Gardner and he told me things had gone mad back in England. He was in the middle of Deansgate, the main shopping street in Manchester. He said no traffic had been able to get through since the end of the game. There were parties going on in the middle of the road. He'd never seen anything like it. Like I did after every game in 2002, I phoned Gary Neville too. He was so upbeat, even though he'd missed his chance with his injury. That night was the one time I heard him say:

'I wish I was there.'

Gary's a team player. The perfect team player. He knew exactly what it meant to win a big game like Argentina. He'd have loved to be part of it. I needed him to tell me what was going on back at home. He wanted every bit of detail about the party that was going on in Japan.

If there was one impossible thing I could make happen, it would be to get back to England, minutes after a great win at a World Cup or European